Cowabunga

SURF REPORT

by GERRY BOT · NORTH PB

MON OCT 26, 2026

DAILY WEEKLY

TODAY'S CALL

GERRY BOT COWABUNGA REPORT · MON OCT 26 · NORTH PB

Same small S swell as yesterday, glassy at dawn, and the NW wind shows up by lunch. PB Drive at first light, seven till half past nine.

Small S, glassy dawn: paddle out by 7:00

PADDLE OUT BY	7:00	BOARD Anvil twin ~73°F WATER

GAME PLAN · MAKE THE MOST OF IT

PB Drive

WINDOW	7–9:30a · Anvil twin · ~73°F
SURF	2–4 ft (SRF), SSW 14s + short NW windswell
TIDE	L 1.3 @ 2:57a H 6.4 @ 9:13a L -0.7 @ 4:10p H 4.1 @ 10:27p obs 5.0 @ 5:54a

Short-period windswell rides on top of the groundswell.

4 /10

SURF RATING · POOR · LIVE

Poor — quick paddle at best

capped by swell 1.6 ft · Better than 2% of 43 logged PB/La Jolla mornings since 09/12

What's in the water

2-4 FT (SRF), SSW 14S + SHORT NW WINDSWELL

GROUND

SwH 1.6–2.0 ft · 13–14s

WINDSWELL

WWH 2.3–2.6 ft · 4–5s

HS BUOY

Hs 2.6–3.3 ft · 46258



FROM

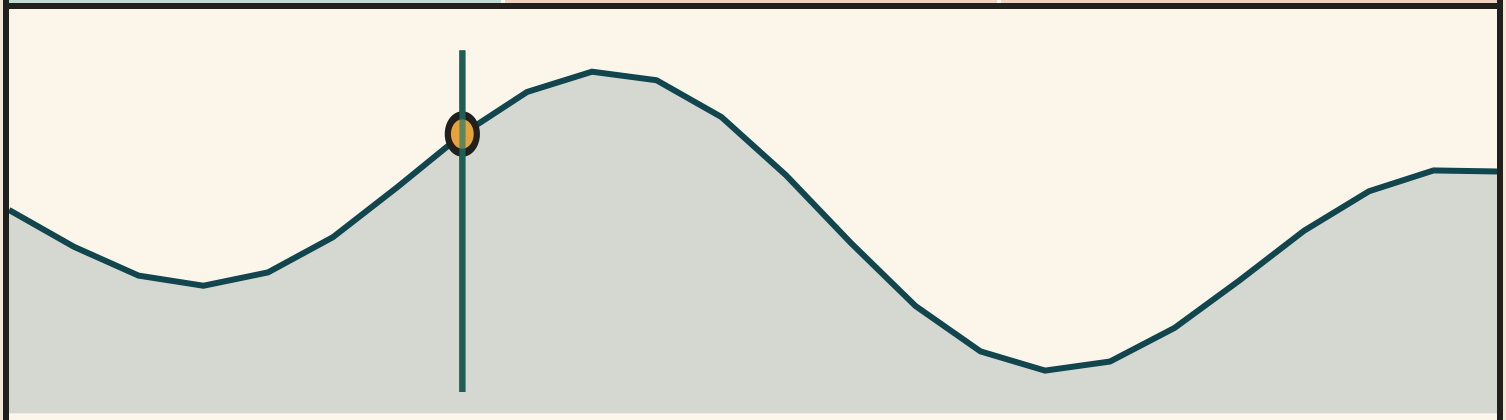
202° SSW

Buoy 46258 · Hs 2.6–3.3 ft (spectrum SwH 1.6–2.0 ft @ 13–14s SSW overnight) + WWH 2.3–2.6 ft @ 4–5s · face 2–4 ft (NWS SRF SD) · PZZ740 S 2 ft @ 14s + NW 3 ft @ 4s · SwD 204° SSW · wind NNE 2 kt at 5a, calm 8–9a, NW from noon

DRAG ACROSS THE DAY

Drag the tide

7–9:30A · PB DRIVE, GLASSY NE TO CALM	11:45A–12:30P · LITTLE POINT, ONLY IF NW STAYS LIGHT	AFTER 12:30P · NW 10 TO 15 MPH, GUSTS 20 KT OFFSHORE WATERS
GO	**MAYBE**	**SKIP**



7:00a	GO · PB Drive, glassy NE to calm	4.9 ft tide	NE ~4 kt · NWS	2–4 ft (SRF), SSW 14s + short NW windswell

L 1.3 @ 2:57a · H 6.4 @ 9:13a · L -0.7 @ 4:10p · H 4.1 @ 10:27p · obs 5.0 @ 5:54a

PB Drive, 7 to about 9:30a, on the Anvil twin. Table tides: H 6.4 @ 9:13a, L –0.7 @ 4:10p, H 4.1 @ 10:27p. The gauge read 4.97 ft at 5:54a, about 1.3 ft over the table, and the SRF says tides are running 1.5–1.7 ft high. LJAC1 was NNE 1–3 kt around 4:48–5:18a. NWS hourly has NE 5 mph 6–7a, calm 8–9a, NW 5 mph 10–11a, NW 10 mph from noon and NW 15 mph 3–4p, sunny. PZZ740 has wind variable under 10 kt, becoming NW 10–15 kt with gusts to 20 kt this afternoon. Get it done before the NW.

Where it's working

★ PB Drive

Scorecard 0.80, basically tied with Little Point, but it is the one that works when the wind does. The S groundswell is holding small at 14 seconds (46258 SwH 0.5–0.6 m, 1.6–2.0 ft, SSW 204°), with a short NW windswell on top. LJAC1 is NNE 1–3 kt at 5a, and NWS has NE 5 mph through 7a, calm 8–9a under sunny skies. The sandbar handles the 6.4 ft high at 9:13a, which the gauge pushes to about 7.7 ft. Expect it fat and a bit backwashy around the top of the tide. Paddle out by 7.

CALL

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2 **Little Point**

Score 0.81, flagged undersized for the reef. The gauge read 4.97 ft at 5:54a, about 1.3 ft over the table, so the reef stays above the 5.5 ft ceiling until about 11:45a. NWS turns the wind NW 10 mph at noon, so it is only worth a look if the NW is late.

MAYBE

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3 **Calumet**

Score 0.61. Swell angle is right, but the tide is far too full for its window. Pass.

SOFT

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4 **PB north of the pier**

Score 0.54. The SSW angle mostly misses the pier wedge.

SOFT

• Skip · Tourmaline (0.54) and PB Point (0.30) go to mush on this tide and are undersized. The Cliffs and OB want a real W groundswell, and the only W energy is a 4–5 second windswell. Blacks and Scripps (extended only) would pull in more of the S, but at 2 ft of groundswell it is not worth the drive.

SKIP

BOARD

Anvil twin

~73°F

QUIVER

Anvil twin fish

Soft waist-high sandbar faces on a very full tide. The twin keeps speed through the fat sections.

TW log · fine if it is closer to waist and slow

'IKE · ONE THING TO REMEMBER

Short-period windswell rides on top of the groundswell.

The buoy shows two trains today: a 14 second S groundswell that carries the real push, and a 4 to 5 second NW windswell that mostly adds texture. Count the seconds between waves in a set. The long gaps are the groundswell, so wait for those and let the choppy short ones go.

SKIP

Little Point before about 11:45a, while the gauge-adjusted tide sits over the 5.5 ft ceiling, and after noon once the NW wind fills in. Calumet, Tourmo and PB Point on a tide this full. The Cliffs and OB on a short NW windswell. Anything after lunch, when it goes NW 10–15 mph.

GOTCHAS

Moderate rip current risk (NWS SRF). The coastal flood warning runs through 1p Thursday, and the high near 7.7 ft on the gauge will wet beach access and the PB boardwalk around 9:13a. The 14 second sets come in small groups with long lulls; watch a full set cycle before paddling out.

HOME STRETCH

PB north · Drive · Tourmo · PB Point · Calumet · Little Point

NOT LOCAL: Cliffs · OB · Scripps · Blacks · North County

▸ THE FULL READOUT · SOURCES